

INCIDENT RESPONSE POLICY

POLICY ELEMENTS

- Policy governing incident response is highly individualized to the organization.
- However, Most policies include the same key elements.

KEY ELEMENTS OF EVERY POLICY

- Statement of management commitment
- Purpose and objectives of the policy
- Scope of the policy
- Definition of Computer Security incidents and related terms

KEY ELEMENTS OF EVERY POLICY

- Organizational Structure and definition of roles, responsibilities and levels of authority
 - Includes the authority of the incident response team to confiscate or disconnect equipment and to monitor suspicious activity
 - Requirements for reporting certain types of incidents
 - Requirements and guidelines for external communications and information sharing
 - Escalation points in the incident management process

KEY ELEMENTS OF EVERY POLICY

- Prioritization or severity ratings of incidents
- Performance measures
- Reporting and contact forms

PLANNING RELATED ELEMENTS

PLAN ELEMENTS

- Organizations should have a formal, focused and coordinated approach to responding to incidents
- Each organization needs a plan that meets its unique requirements
- Unique requirements relates to
 - Organization's mission
 - Organization's size
 - Organization's structure
 - Organization's functions

PLAN ELEMENTS

- Plan should include the following elements:
 - Mission
 - Strategies and goals
 - Senior Management approval
 - Organizational approach to incident response
 - How the incident response team will communicate with the rest of the organization and with other organization
 - Roadmap for incident response capability
 - How the program fits into the overall organization2

SHARING INFORMATION WITH OUTSIDE PARTIES

SHARING OF THE INFORMATION

- Organization often need to communicate with outside parties regarding incident
- It may include
 - Contacting law enforcement
 - Fielding media inquiries
 - Seeking external expertise

SHARING OF THE INFORMATION

- Another example can be – discussing incidents with other involved parties
 - ISP
 - The vendor of vulnerable software
 - Other Incident response teams
- Organizations may also proactively share relevant information with peers to improve detection and analysis of incidents
- Team should discuss information sharing with organization's public affair office, legal department and management to establish policies and procedures.

COMMUNICATION WITH OUTSIDE PARTIES



